

LEAKLISTEN · REQUIREMENTS

LeakListen requirements

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document ID	LKL-REQ-001	Version	0.4
Status	Draft	Date	2026-09-25
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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/leaklisten		
Source	docs/03-requirements.md @ 64c9800		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.4	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Recommendations accepted by Amish (DDR-002): R1 and R2 restated (contact sensor for metallic mains, hydrophone variant for plastic); R7 restated against a district gateway within 0.5 km under iron covers; R9 met with the 42 mm magnet; status from LKL-CAL-001 v0.2
0.3	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	TRL 3, status from LKL-CAL-001 for every requirement; R8 fixed (LKL-DDR-001 D6); R5 and R14 note the weekly time correction and the 24-byte summary
0.2	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First measurable requirements for TRL 2, with status against the concept
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Initial scaffold

LeakListen requirements

These are first-pass requirements for one logger. Targets are proposals for review; they come from desk research, not yet from a partner utility, and must be revised after co-design (see the problem statement, LKL-PRB-001). Status is judged against the design in LKL-PRC-001 v0.4 by the calculations in LKL-CAL-001 v0.2, which print every figure quoted here. The TRL 2 review decisions are recorded in LKL-DDR-001. The TRL 3 review decisions, accepted by Amish on 2026-09-25, are recorded in LKL-DDR-002: they restate R2 (plastic mains are served by the hydrophone variant) and R7 (a gateway within 0.5 km of each district with iron covers); no numeric target is lowered.

Table 1. Requirements and status at TRL 3 (LKL-CAL-001).

ID	Requirement	Target	Verification	Status at TRL 3
R1	Hear a leak on metallic mains (contact sensor)	Flag a 5 L/min (1.3 US gal/min) leak at 3 bar within 100 m of the logger on cast or ductile iron DN100 to DN200. The magnet-on contact sensor's scope is metallic mains (LKL-DDR-002)	Attenuation and detection estimate (LKL-CAL-001 section G); later a partner site with a controlled leak	At risk: about 185 m on ductile iron at the central estimate, 93 to 370 m over plausible pipe losses
R2	Hear a leak on plastic mains (hydrophone variant)	Same leak within 30 m on PVC or PE DN100 to DN200, with the hydrophone variant on a hydrant or tapping point (LKL-DDR-002, D3)	As R1, for the hydrophone variant	Open: the hydrophone variant is not sized at TRL 3. For the record, the contact sensor, now out of scope for plastic, hears about 4 m on PVC and 2 m on PE
R3	Sensor bandwidth	5 Hz to 2 kHz, within ± 3 dB after correction	Resonance estimate (LKL-CAL-001 section F); later a shaker comparison	At risk: with the 42 mm magnet the mount resonates at about 695 to 1,390 Hz, flat only to 380 to 750 Hz
R4	Sensor self-noise	Equivalent input noise 1 $\mu\text{g}/\text{VHz}$ or less from 100 Hz to 1 kHz	Noise calculation (LKL-CAL-001 section F)	At risk: 1.03 $\mu\text{g}/\text{VHz}$ worst case with the 53 g seismic mass
R5	Night listening	12 windows of 20 s between 02:00 and 04:00 local time, clock drift under 1 min per month	Clock drift estimate (LKL-CAL-001 section H)	Met on paper with a weekly network time correction (20 s worst); 87 s a month free running
R6	Battery life	5 years or more on one primary cell at the R5 schedule and one uplink a night	Power budget (LKL-CAL-001 section C)	Met on paper: 10.3 years or more on energy; taken as 10 years
R7	Radio link	90 % or more of nightly summaries delivered from a chamber with a cast-iron cover to a gateway planned within 0.5 km of each such district; 1 km where the utility agrees to a composite cover or a through-cover antenna (LKL-DDR-002)	Link budget (LKL-CAL-001 section D); cover loss measurement and field check later (TRL 4, on hold)	At risk: +0.9 dB at 0.5 km under a 20 dB iron cover (EU868 SF12), -1.2 dB for US915 SF9, -9.1 dB for a tight 30 dB cover; cover loss unmeasured
R8	Data and privacy	Only band levels and spectra leave the logger; raw vibration samples are deleted on the device after processing. Fixed requirement (LKL-DDR-001 D6)	Design review	Met by design
R9	Attachment	Magnet holds 100 N or more on a steel or iron spindle cap, with no tools or pipe work	Hold estimate (LKL-CAL-001 section I); a pull test later	Met on paper with the 42 mm magnet (LKL-DDR-002): 125 N on a 0.5 mm coating, 187 N on 0.3 mm. Non-ferrous fittings, outside this target, need an adapter
R10	Install from the surface		Task estimate (LKL-CAL-001 section K); a	

ID	Requirement	Target	Verification	Status at TRL 3
		Placed and recovered in 10 min or less without entering the chamber, for chambers up to 1.5 m deep	walk-through with the partner utility	Not verifiable at TRL 3: 10 min estimate; cable reaches caps 2.09 m down
R11	Survive the chamber	IP68: 1 m submersion for 7 days; operate from -20 to +50 °C	Design review (LKL-CAL-001 section J)	Met by design; the logger floats on its lanyard when flooded
R12	Size and mass	Logger 70 mm diameter or less and 300 mm long or less; total mass 1.0 kg or less	Parametric model (LKL-CAL-001 section K)	Met on paper: 63 x 267 mm overall, 0.98 kg
R13	Leak flag quality	1 false alarm or fewer per 20 loggers per month after a 14-night baseline	Field data from a partner network	Not verifiable at TRL 3
R14	Open and interoperable	Standard LoRaWAN 1.0.x uplink (1.0.3 for the time request), documented 24-byte payload, works with any network server and TwinKit	Design review (LKL-CAL-001 sections A and B)	Met by design
R15	Cost	Parts cost \$130 or less per logger	Priced BOM (LKL-CAL-001 section M)	Met on paper: \$113.00

■ Requirements at risk or open

Summary (LKL-CAL-001 v0.2, Table 6): none not met, 4 at risk, 1 open (R2, variant not sized), 2 not verifiable at TRL 3, 5 met on paper and 3 met by design. Before LKL-DDR-002 there were 2 not met (R2, R7) and 4 at risk (R1, R3, R4, R9).

- **R7 at risk.** At an assumed 20 dB cover loss the link closes to about 0.53 km in EU868 and 0.46 km in US915. Under LKL-DDR-002 a gateway is planned within 0.5 km of each district with iron covers, which EU868 SF12 reaches with +0.9 dB to spare and US915 SF9 misses by 1.2 dB. The cover loss must be measured first; that is TRL 4 work and on hold.
- **R2 open.** Leak noise attenuates quickly on plastic pipes (0.42 dB/m at 100 Hz on PVC against 0.011 dB/m on ductile iron), and a contact sensor on a valve hears the reference leak only a few metres along PVC or PE. Under LKL-DDR-002 R2 applies to the hydrophone variant (LKL-DDR-001 D3), which is not yet sized.
- **R1 at risk.** The central estimate of 185 m on iron clears 100 m, but pipe loss and leak source strength are both uncertain by large factors.
- **R3 at risk.** The magnet mount's resonance falls inside the band and varies by site; the heavier 42 mm magnet lowers it by about 10 %.
- **R4 at risk.** 1.03 µg/VHz against 1 µg/VHz, on assumed ceramic and op-amp data.
- **R9 met on paper** with the 42 mm magnet (LKL-DDR-002); it was at risk with the 32 mm magnet (90 N at a 0.3 mm coating). Brass, bronze or plastic fittings still need an adapter.
- **R10 and R13 not verifiable at TRL 3.** They need a walk-through and field data with a partner utility.

■ Assumptions

- Network pressure at night 2 to 6 bar; leaks at lower pressure are quieter.

- Valve spindle caps and hydrant bodies are cast iron or steel on most networks the lab would target first.
- A LoRaWAN gateway (Twinkit, a partner's or a public network) is within about 1 km in an urban area, and within about 0.5 km of each district with cast-iron covers (LKL-DDR-002).
- Transmit power follows the regional limit: +14 dBm in EU868, up to +20 dBm in US915.
- Primary cell: lithium thionyl chloride C size, 3.6 V, about 7.7 Ah nominal, derated to 70 % usable for cold and pulse loads.

■ Safety requirements

Safety: S1: no confined space entry is needed to place, service or recover a logger. S2: the cell is a primary lithium cell with a fuse or PTC and reverse protection; no charging circuit is fitted. S3: the logger carries a label with the owner, a contact and a lithium cell warning. S4: nothing touches drinking water, and nothing is fixed to the pipe other than the magnet.